with India serving as a guarantor of a proposed accord between them. In 2006, a comprehensive peace accord was signed between the political parties and the Maoists, that ended the civil war. But the constitutional crisis involving the king continued. Popular protests began, and the next year, after receiving assurances, Gyanendra agreed to withdraw from an executive role. India helped ensure the army's backing for this transition. But while the king continued to advocate for a constitutional monarchy, the Nepali public had become more hostile to any form of monarchy. In 2008, Nepal's monarchy came to an end after over two centuries and the country became a republic. [45] But the consequences included a left-wing turn in Nepal's national politics, with implications for its foreign relations, including with India.

The other momentous regional development was the end of the long-running Sri Lankan civil war. In December 2006, the Sri Lankan army began a major offensive, sweeping into the Eastern Province with the help of the defection of a former LTTE commander. The next year, it began its campaign in the Northern Province, resulting in the fall of Kilinochchi and Jaffna. By April and May 2009, the last remnants of LTTE support were holed up in a small coastal area along with large numbers of displaced civilians. While the international community pushed for a ceasefire, India coordinated closely with the Sri Lankan government, advocating safe zones for civilians and providing medical, infrastructural, and de-mining assistance, while politically protecting President Mahinda Rajapaksa and other Sri Lankan leaders from international mediation and allegations of war crimes. The final assault in mid-May resulted in a bloodbath that also saw the death of the LTTE leadership, including Prabhakaran. The result was that after almost three decades, the Sri Lankan civil war came to a decisive end. [46] For India, this eliminated what was once a major national security threat. But, in time, it opened a new set of issues with its southern island neighbour.

The decade after India's 1998 nuclear tests was therefore eventful. This period featured multiple crises with Pakistan that contributed over time to a 'de-hyphenating' of relations, the resetting of India's ties with the United